

OLIVER B. MENKEN, B.S.

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EDUCATION

M.D., SUNY Downstate College of Medicine, Brooklyn, NY 08/2023-Expected 05/2027

B.S., Biology, Studio Art Minor, Tufts University, Medford, MA 09/2017-06/2021
Summa cum laude, Deans list

EMPLOYMENT

Icahn School of Medicine at Mount Sinai, Radiation Oncology, New York, NY 09/2021-06/2023
Clinical Research Coordinator

- Monitored, coordinated, and conducted 20+ clinical trials studying novel oncology treatment

Jono Pandolfi Designs Inc., Union City, NJ 05/2019-08/2019
Ceramics Production Assistant

- Produced handmade ceramic dinnerware for Michelin-starred restaurants including but not limited to, Momofuku, Jean-Georges, Eleven Madison Park, and the NoMad Hotel

LEADERSHIP

Near Peer Educator Pathway, SUNY Downstate, Brooklyn, NY 03/2026-Present
Senior Educator

- Leads near-peer instruction and mentorship sessions to pre-clinical medical students consisting of clinical skills, radiology, histology, anatomy, and tutoring to support their academic development and progression through the medical school curriculum

Surgery Society, SUNY Downstate, Brooklyn, NY 01/2024-Present
President | 01/2025-Present

- Orchestrate executive leadership, manage events including suture clinics and match panels, coordinate cross-departmental collaborations with multiple specialty groups, and spearhead community outreach initiatives including health fairs and donor drives

Secretary | 01/2024-01/2025

- Recorded and maintained notes from club meetings, facilitated partnerships with other surgical groups on campus, and oversaw communication with administration and student body

Global Surgery Student Alliance, SUNY Downstate, Brooklyn, NY 04/2024-Present

Secretary | 04/2025-Present

- Maintain organizational integrity by documenting proceedings, ensuring regulatory compliance through timely submission of required documentation, and managing all official communications through appropriate channels to maximize member engagement and participation

Event Coordinator | 04/2024-04/2025

- Planned, coordinated, and advertised events such as suture clinics, lectures with global surgeons, and partnerships with other global health groups

Peer Mentorship and Wellness Program, SUNY Downstate, Brooklyn, NY

08/2024-02/2025

Peer Wellness Mentor

- Provided personalized guidance to incoming students by sharing academic strategies, facilitating regular supportive check-ins throughout the academic year, and serving as an accessible resource during transitional challenges for first-year medical students

Unofficial Skate Collective/SKATE ESSEX Non-Profit, Montclair, NJ

05/2020-02/2023

Co-Founder and Board Member

- Volunteer non-profit advocacy group for the empowerment of Northern New Jersey skateboarders
- Spearheaded the lobbying of the Montclair Township for a safe space for skateboarders--including \$50,000+ awarded in funding for construction and partnership with Olympian skateboarder and architect Alexis Sablone

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

SUNY Downstate Department of Urology, Brooklyn, NY

05/2025-Present

Research Assistant

- Assists Dr. Jeffrey P. Weiss in analysis of varied patient cohorts throughout the Brooklyn catchment area to characterize relationships among heart failure, lower urinary tract symptoms, nocturia physiology, patient-centered treatment preferences, and prostate MRI diagnostic utility.

Duke School of Medicine Department of Orthopaedic Spinal Surgery, Durham, NC

05/2024-Present

Research Assistant

- Assist Dr. Peter G. Passias in examination of spinal alignment restoration, mechanical complications, and varying surgical techniques for interbody device placement in an effort to improve patient outcomes across various research initiatives

SUNY Downstate Department of Orthopedic Surgery, Brooklyn, NY

09/2023-Present

Research Assistant

- Assist Dr. Eric Tischler by surveying and evaluating patient perspectives on telehealth orthopedic appointments among the Afro-Caribbean population in Brooklyn, NY

UCSF Weill Institute for Neurosciences, San Francisco, CA

05/2018-06/2018

Research Assistant

- Assisted Dr. Maggie Waung in mapping neurologic pathways responsible for migraine pathophysiology through optogenetic methods and ex vivo brain slice whole cell physiology and pharmacology

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Office of Student Admissions, SUNY Downstate, Brooklyn, NY

12/2023-Present

Peer-to-peer Interviewer/Student Ambassador

- Participate in selecting the next class of medical students for SUNY Downstate College of Medicine
- Provide tours, meet with applicants, and conduct interviews

The Anne Kastor Brooklyn Free Clinic, SUNY Downstate, Brooklyn, NY

10/2023-Present

Senior Volunteer Student Doctor | 11/2025-Present

- Oversee, manage, and teach students how to conduct patient histories, perform focused physical exams, and report findings to an attending physician

Junior Volunteer Student Doctor | 10/2023-11/2025

- Conducted full patient histories, performed focused physical exams, and reported findings to an attending physician

Private Tutor, Brooklyn, NY

08/2023-Present

Tutor

- Provide one-on-one assistance to students 12-18 years of age in algebra, geometry, and chemistry

The Bowery Mission Community Shelter, New York, NY

4/2022-04/2023

Volunteer

- Assisted the unhoused populations of Manhattan by providing temporary housing and meals
- Prepared and served food, assisted in clean-up, sorted and organized donations

Massachusetts General Hospital Orthopedic Ambulatory Center, Waltham, MA

08/2018-12/2019

Volunteer Patient Care Technician

- Assisted in pre-op and PACU, transported upon intake and discharge

BIBLIOGRAPHY

Publications

Kaplan-Marans, E., **Menken, O.**, Brannigan, R., (2026) *Half of Infertility Involves Men, Yet Care Remains Female-Centric: Structural Drivers of an Imbalanced System.*

- Under review at Urology Practice.

Menken, O., Gross, P., Lainis, Z. (2026) *When Reliability Replaces Morality: The Cost of Standardizing Decision-Making Capacity.*

- Under review at The Journal of Medical Ethics.

Menken, O., Canning, C., Moosikasuwan, J., Antonellis, M., Lin, C., Weng, S., Muneeb, M., Christolin, S., Karanikolas, N., Weiss, J. (2026) *Do We Need the Dynamic Contrast-Enhanced Component of MRI? A*

Comparison of Prostate Biopsy Rates and Management of Upstaged Lesions, PIRADS 3 Peripheral Zone Lesions, and PIRADS 4 Lesions.

- Under review at Clinical Genitourinary Cancer.

Abstracts/Poster Presentations

Kaplan-Marans, E., **Menken, O.**, Brannigan, R. (2026) *Imbalance and Geographic Disparities in the U.S. Fertility Workforce: Reproductive Endocrinology, Reproductive Urology, and Insurance Mandates.* ASRM 2026 Scientific Congress & Expo, 24-28 Oct. 2026, Baltimore, MD.

Menken, O., Daly, M., Antonellis, M., Heaney, C., Gray, K., Karanikolas, N., Weiss, J. (2026) *Polyuria and Urgency Correlates in Men with Lower Urinary Tract Symptoms.* Urologic Society for American Veterans Annual Meeting, 17 May 2026, Washington DC.

Menken, O., Gross, P., Lainis, Z. (2026) *When Reliability Replaces Morality: The Cost of Standardizing Decision-Making Capacity.* Albany Medical College 10th Annual Medical Student Ethics Conference, 18 Apr. 2026, New York Academy of Medicine New York, NY.

Lainis, Z., Zhou, S., Beck, T., **Menken, O.**, Shevde, K. (2026) *The Portrait of an Anesthesiologist Through the Eyes of AI: A Demographic Analysis.* Society for Technology in Anesthesia 2026 Annual Meeting, 15-28 Jan. 2026, Tampa, FL.

Yung, A., Fisher, M. R., Onafowokan, O. O., **Menken, O.**, Wu, C., Parsons, A., Prado, I., Ivasyk, I., Lorentz, N., Galetta, M., Cottrill, E., Than, K. D., Passias, P. G. (2025) *Optimizing Mental Health Conditions Prior to Adult Cervical Deformity Surgery: Does Preoperative Optimization Improve Surgical Outcomes?.* 32nd International Meeting on Advanced Spine Techniques, 2-5 Apr. 2025, Glasgow, Scotland.

- Whitecloud Award Nominee--Best Clinical Paper

Yung, A., Fisher, M. R., Das, A., Onafowokan, O. O., Ivasyk, I., Prado, I., Wu, C., Galetta, M., Lorentz, N., **Menken, O.**, Cottrill, E., Jankowski, P., Than, K. D., Passias, P. G. (2025) *What Drives Cost during Adult Cervical Deformity Surgery?: Identifying High Cost Surgical Components and their Effect on Outcomes.* 32nd International Meeting on Advanced Spine Techniques, 2-5 Apr. 2025, Glasgow, Scotland.

Menken, O., Krasnyanski, B., Kong, R., Alam, J., Newen, N., Saints, B., Patel, N., Tozzi, D., Day, L., Urban, W. (2024). *General versus Regional Anesthesia in Acromioclavicular Joint Reconstruction: A NSQIP Analysis between 2008 and 2016.* 2024 SUNY Downstate Annual Research Day, 27 Apr. 2024, Brooklyn, NY.

Shin, J., Hsieh, K., **Menken, O.**, Buckstein, M. (2022). Salvage Ablative Radiation Therapy for Isolated Intraabdominal Recurrences of Hepatocellular Carcinoma. *International Journal of Radiation Oncology, Biology, Physics*, 114(3), e180-181. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijrobp.2022.07.1076>

- Presented at 2022 ASTRO Annual Meeting, 23-26 Oct. 2022, San Antonio, TX.

Dickstein, D. R., Lehrer, E., Van Hyfte, G., **Menken, O.**, Rath, L., Hsieh, K., Hotca-Cho, A., Powers, A., Reed, S., Sharma, S., Liu, J., Gupta, V., Dutta, P., Roof, S., Misiukiewicz, K., Culliney, B., Posner, M., Genden, E., Bakst, R. L. (2022). Hypofractionated Radiotherapy for Elderly Patients with Head and Neck Squamous Cell Carcinoma – Interim Results from a Prospective Phase II Trial. *American Journal of Clinical Oncology*, 45(9), S11-S12. <https://journals.lww.com/amjclinicaloncology/toc/2022/09000>
- Presented at 2022 ARS Annual Meeting, 19-22 May 2022, Scottsdale, AZ.

HOBBIES & INTERESTS

Ceramics, Canoe Camping, Bowling, Chess, Basketball, Guitar